

Michael Kenyon
Creative Writing
Final Portfolio

Poetry:

Coffee

I pour myself a cup of coffee

And the pot always drips.

I pour faster.

I pour slower.

Higher.

Lower.

It always drips.

Staining the countertop.

Stinging my hand.

My coffee isn't even good.

It's dark.

It's hot.

I get precious little out of it

But I like the mug.

My new favorite thing.

I get a new one every week.

I spill coffee down the side.

It makes rings on the table.

I clean it up with the mail

because the mail is always coming.

Always boring.

Always nothing.

So I throw it away.

Into a trash can filled with coffee grounds

I don't remember buying.

I'm hungry.

Out of eggs.

I go to a diner

where they have special food

for a special price

for special people.

I get served by a lady

Who is too nice to me

Too close to me.

Two eggs for me.

I give her all my money.

She gives me all her coffee.

She doesn't spill a drop.

A sailing ship

A sailing ship
Raises its white sails
And glides out
Onto the open waves
You see how it gets smaller and smaller
And where the sea and sky meet
It disappears
When someone says "it has gone"
Another calls out, "It has arrived."
For death is a horizon
And a horizon is nothing more
Then the limit of our vision
When we mourn the passing of our loved ones
Others are happy to see them again
On the other side of the horizon

The Disease

It comes like the thief in the night,
Takes you by surprise, and then invades your entire body, kind of like the venom from a spider bite

Symptoms do include anxiety, trust issues, and overthinking every situation, sacrifices, too many chances with internal liberations, conversations lead to arguments, which then turns to frustration, all for it to come back to you saying you're sorry and that you were mistaken

When all you did was express how you felt, but that doesn't matter cause this thing right here is what keeps you held together,

Fellas, it's what makes us give our hoodies to her even if it is bad weather, cause yes indeed we do start to freeze, but if she asks, we say we're good because we see that she's doing better.

Ladies, it's what makes y'all sit there when we are on the game, no, our attention isn't fully on you, but you see that we are happy, so that happiness trails back to you all the same.

No, this is not a disease, and it was there would be no vaccine, because this thing called love is immensely more than what it seems.

Fiction

Michael Kenyon
Creative Writing

Up In Ashes

Lily had entered the Roosevelt Hotel with a passion only somebody who knew grief personally could muster, and she had walked with the experience of a thousand doors slamming. Her posture had been horrible, her shoulders slouched forward, and her neck, though long, had always portrayed itself unusually and unnaturally forward. She didn't have much luggage with her, just two powder blue cases. She wore sunglasses that covered the majority of her face, and a cigarette hung out of the corner of her pink-stained lips. She had been wearing a peacoat and had flipped the collar up against her neck, probably in a vain attempt to keep out the wind. A prominent bump stuck out of her jacket as she walked, offsetting her balance as though it was something new to her. Lily had dropped her bags in front of the reception desk, leaned over the side, grabbed a key, left a twenty on the marble counter, picked up her bags, and headed towards the elevator. Her shoes echoed against the polished wood, and she didn't take a moment to look around her, though what a sight it was. The ceilings of the lobby arched and bowed in an alluring charm, and the chandeliers chimed in the wind when a force pushed the revolving doors a slight too quick. The concierge wore a bright red suit with golden lapels, not a strand out of place. When Lily had entered, he had been talking to an older woman holding a small white dog; she had been complaining about the cold weather, while the boy nodded along in faux empathy. Gaudy displays of wealth surrounded the large interior, demonstrated heavily by a man smoking a Montecristo that sat in a large velvet chair, reading the paper in the languor of the small atmosphere around him. A couple waited at the front desk, checking their watches every few minutes, the man sighing impatiently now and then. While bell boys bustled around the squeaky floors and laughs rose with smoke, the newcomer had closed herself in the elevator. The only word Lily had said that afternoon was "twelve" after being requested her floor.

When the elevator opened its heavy gold doors, Lily, who hadn't let go of her luggage on the short lift up strode easily out and slipped the operator a nickel. Only when she had reached her room did she take off her sunglasses and throw her bags on the bed. The cigarette had burned quickly, the ashes caking at the end until a soft powder fell on the bedspread. Lily hadn't bothered to clean them up. The room was quiet. She crossed to the window and pulled the curtains aside, tugging against the fragile rod until the curtains stayed behind the hook on the wall. She stared down at the traffic below her, squinting in the gray sunlight. She watched a group of women walking with haughty importance, and she watched the doorman take off his cap to wave it at someone across the street. Lily turned from the window and trilled her lips at the room, she began to pace. The cigarette had lost its glow and she was acutely aware of that as the hot ash kissed her bottom lip, she spat the butt quickly into the ashtray and stared down at the remains, a defeated whimper escaped her mouth. Lily stood vacantly at the end of the bed, pressed the heels of her palms into her eyes, and shook her head. A curtain fell from its hook and she snapped her neck back up, eyes blurred and red from rubbing. Her makeup had been smudged and one of her lips was slightly burnt in one place. Her bags were laying heavy on the duvet cover, and the yellowing walls around Lily seemed to shrink around her. She stuck her hand in her coat pockets, feeling every corner but came out empty. She then dumped the contents of both suitcases onto the floor and sifted through the pile of clothes. A soft vanilla and cinnamon scent began to soak through everything as she sat defeatedly on the ground and Lily knew that she had broken her perfume bottle. She put one hand on the floor, the other on her swelling stomach, and stood up. She kicked the now-soaked clothes into the corner of the room, but then kicked the suitcases against the wall with them for good measure. As the fermented scent sank itself into the carpet Lily began to cry, she really did use to love that smell but now it burned a sickly sweet slap through her nose and into her lungs. Lily needed another cigarette.

Jack was brilliant, he was a creator of dreams and he seemed to hold each endless opportunity in his soft hands. He had come from a family of wealth, everybody had known, but he remained humble in every circumstance. He had never fallen in love before but he had always imagined it would be his biggest accomplishment. He was never satisfied in much of anything that he did, and every small victory

was only a mere step towards some goal only he could see. So when Lily had met this boy on a field trip her senior year for her French class to the local movie theater, (it was to see a documentary called *À propos de Nice*), the both of them left with a different spirit. Jack was astounded by Lily's easygoing humor and beauty, Lily had seen Jack's potential and his lovely face. After that day, still in college, Jack would wait for Lily in his shining car outside of the town High School for her, and Lily bought a nicer pair of shoes. She began to hang around him everywhere, skipping class and crawling out of her first-floor window into the night, her parents didn't mind, and barely objected when she told them she was leaving for Los Angeles. They were thrilled really, they were happy she had found a boy who could take care of her and settle down, maybe have a family someday. Lily had packed one bag with most of her favorite belongings and hopped on a train with Jack the next morning. She had slept on his shoulder for most of the ride, hand in hand, and Jack was content. He had his share of worries as anyone does when moving across the country, but at that moment he felt right with Lily by his side.

As the pair settled into their new town, they married at the City Hall, rented out a small apartment across from the Brighton Coffee Shop, and fell even more in love. Lily got a job at the cross street business, and Jack began collecting newspapers feverishly circling job opportunities, then leaving at strange hours of the day for an interview. He applied at two publishing companies, three accounting jobs, and several others that Lily eventually forgot about. In the following April, Jack found a position as an assistant to the current head of MGM in Hollywood, he was offered the job immediately. Lily dropped one of her shifts. Jack began to take Lily out for dinners, and began buying new throw pillows, he began taking Lily dancing. She started to spend more money on groceries and getting her hair done often.

On a Monday one July, the pair was walking on the warm sands of a beach shoes hanging off of hooked fingers, left hand in right.

"Jack," Lily had started, "where do you see yourself in ten years?" Jack didn't even hesitate.

"With you," and he squeezed her hand. Lily had smiled, but she wasn't happy, of course, she wanted to be with him but she didn't expect his only priority to be her. Lily had always taken things seriously, this was an unsatisfactory answer and it felt like a lie. Lily asked him again,

“Seriously, Jack, what are you going to do with your life?” Now Jack was the unhappy one, he didn’t like to be rushed, or seen as incompetent, a constant battle he fought with himself.

“Successful.” He replied, after more time squinting in the direction of the sun. “Successful and happy.” Lily didn’t prod for more, but she had wished he’d had a plan.

A few summers later, as Jack began to climb the ladder at the producing company, Lily began to see less and less of him. He had begun to try his hand at auditions, parts that could guide him to something big, and one day it finally happened. Jack earned the role of a leading man in an upcoming Cukor film. Lily and Jack had celebrated that night with expensive champagne and oysters at a restaurant on the water.

“Lily,” Jack had said that night, “you are my inspiration, my joy, and my better half.” Then they touched their glasses together in a small toast.

A year later, the movie had released and it was a hit. Jack was already signing contracts for enticing new projects as Lily found herself attending more and more parties. She enjoyed it at first, but as the numbers kept rising and the champagne became less of a treat, she grew tired. She grew lonely in rooms full of people, most she didn’t know but had seen pour their hearts to her several times larger than their size. At one particular party, held at the home of some actress, Lily sat at a long oak table sipping an Old Fashioned and laughing politely as the hostess barked at her own jokes, enjoying herself very much. As the night was reaching the point of heavy eyes and slurred talk, Lily rose to get air. She had sluggishly slipped through conversations to the door and inhaled deeply in the bright evening. It had been a beautiful scene, every star was visible and every home was illuminated in warm yellow, tossed across a pile of hills. Thinking she was alone in this serenity, Lily leaned against the rail of the balcony and pressed her head against her forearms.

“Not having fun?” A voice rose out of the silken evening. Lily startled and fixed her posture.

“I’m just fine.” She had replied and turned to go back inside.

“Here doll, this will help,” before she could reach for the door, a young man had reached out and a cigarette butt glowed orange in front of her. She looked down at the tinged paper and back to the man, one eyebrow raised.

“I don’t smoke, but thank you,” she replied coolly.

“Everybody smokes.” He had replied. Lily looked him over, he had been in Jack’s movie, he did alright. But the night was clear, and maybe it was the lonesome ache she could never seem to keep down or the bubbles of a thousand glasses of champagne from a thousand parties. Either way, Lily gave in.

“Fine.” She took the cigarette, trying to ignore the stare her husband was giving the pair through the glass door, breathed in the bitter smoke, and promptly threw up.

Lily was pregnant, and she had been for a few weeks. Jack was thrilled, and Lily found herself enjoying a new angle of life. On a cold evening, wrapped in a shawl, Lily sat smoking, a new habit of hers, and Jack sat with a whiskey. Lily had asked,

“What should we name them?” and smiled at her hand that rested on her growing belly.

“Benjamin,” Jack replied after a moment of contemplation.

“Like your father,” Lily smiled, “very sweet.” Jack had smiled back at her.

“But what if they’re a girl?”

“Then you decide.” He replied, setting his now empty glass on the table. He made the motion to get up and refill it, but Lily cleared her throat.

“Jack, I don’t want you drinking so much anymore.” Her eyes remained intent on the wooden surface in front of her. Jack paused, halfway out of his seat. His eyebrows furrowed, creating uneven lines on his face that Lily had only seen on screen.

“I don’t drink that much,” he answered and proceeded to get up.

“That’s going to be your fourth tonight.” Lily was more defiant now and she put the cigarette out in her ashtray.

“So? That was *your* third.” His eyes were growing icy, he had never been in favor of Lily smoking, even though everyone else really did do it. Lily pursed her lips and stared at her husband with a knot in her chest, she could feel the unease in the air.

“Please.” She sighed in little more than a whisper. She reached out to hold his hand onto her stomach. Jack’s eyes grew soft at this, and he set his glass on the table.

“Alright.” Lily inhaled the warm smell of Jack into her chest, fresh laundry soap and cologne weaved together with makeup from set and stale gin as she hugged his strong frame.

Lily went to the kitchen to clean up, and Jack poured another glass before he slipped up the stairs to take a bath. When Lily had gone back to clear the table and didn’t see Jack’s glass, she threw every bottle of alcohol in the house from the second-floor bedroom window, cursing under her breath with each one. Jack had been furious, he had said they were expensive drinks, Lily had said he cared more for them than his child. Jack had slapped her, and Lily put her cigarette out on his hand. Jack apologized and bought Lily a bouquet of flowers. This only began the series of quarrels that would steal the shine from Jack’s eyes and make Lily rarely leave the house. Of course, they would always resolve whatever would come up with pink carnations, whether it be who their child’s godparents were, how long Lily would spend in the shower, or how many times empty bottles were found hidden under the full trash bags.

When Lily was seven months, she didn’t feel quite like going to parties anymore, she felt like laying in bed with a warm compress reading a book, so she did just that. While Jack was out with costars and new friends, Lily lay in the silence of her large home. She never liked being there alone, and she found herself humming herself to sleep to fill the silence of the place her husband once lay. Lily would have dreams of Jack holding her in the dark of their first apartment, she would dream of stealing sips of stale coffee during breaks. Her mind would drift to home, and to Jack at the movie theater counter, she would often wake smiling before the white walls hugging her abrasively and the hungover snores of Jack truly woke her up.

On a warm September morning, Lily woke to an empty bed, made all the more obvious by the silence of the room around her, only a bird sang a good morning through the curtained windows. She had slowly

gotten up, ignoring the pain in her back, and descended to the kitchen. The light beat against the blue walls, and there was a still breath in the air- as if a white lie had just been told. Lily poured herself a cup of coffee, and sat alone at the table, in the silence, in the emptiness. At half-past noon, Jack walked through the door, a bouquet of carnations tucked under his arm, Lily had dozed off at the table but woke to the sound of the door unlocking. Jack walked over to her and set the flowers by her folded arms.

“Good morning.” He kissed her on the top of her head and poured himself a cup of coffee, splashing a bit of something in his.

“Jack you can’t be serious.” Lily glared at his hand putting the small flask back into his coat pocket. “You smell bad too,” she remarked.

“Just for you,” he joked and smothered her in a hug.

“What is up with you?” Lily had to suppress a smile, she chose to ignore his mug, she had missed him.

“Can’t a man just love his wife?” He had asked, pressing another kiss on her head. Lily leaned into him and smiled into his collar, she had longed for this moment even in sleep. She hummed against him as a deep stench of floral perfume and powder hit her nose. She pulled back slowly, before leaning in and smelling again.

“What were you doing out all night?” She asked him, her eyes large and entirely focused on his own. Jack moved into the kitchen, sifting the counters for the sugar packets.

“Just lost track of time, you know how I am.” He had smiled quickly and took a sip of his coffee looking away from his wife, staring directly at the steaming drink. Jack had never been a good liar. It was funny to Lily at that moment that he had decided to be an actor and succeeded. A laugh escaped her lips and Jack looked at her worried. She looked down at his hands where his wedding band had been put on only to the knuckle, quietly in haste. Maybe in a car, or maybe a hotel room, never his own bed.

“Obviously I don’t because you have never once gotten *carried away* until noon.” Lily was standing now, nostrils flaring. He knew that she knew.

“Lily- I’m so sorry-”

“*Carnations*? This whole time... You are so dense,” Lily exclaimed in shock then in realization. She had picked up the bouquet and shook them in his face. “You are horrible.” She threw them at his feet, and petals scattered around their shoes. Her eyes were full of tears now, and she could feel her patience about to snap with a handful of her nerves.

“Lily please.” Jack reached out and tried to hold her hands, she shook him off.

“How long? How long Jack?” She had asked, her voice growing to a high falsetto. Jack looked down.

“Two months.” Two months for Lily to make a fool of herself. Two months for Jack to lose the one thing Lily was sure he could never have again.

“Ohhh, oh no.” She groaned and tears slipped down her face reluctantly. “I’m leaving.” A husky voice now left her lips, she wrapped her arms protectively around her waist.

“Lily don’t, you know that would be a mistake,” he paused, “where else do you have to go anyways?” Jack stood dejectedly in the kitchen as Lily began backing away from him.

“Somewhere. I don’t know. Anywhere but, but here, I don’t know.” She wiped her face with one hand and turned up the stairs. She packed two suitcases and threw a coat over her nightdress. When Lily walked out the door, all she said was: “You would have been a poor excuse for a dad anyway.” Jack had smashed a glass and cut his hand, he stood over the sink running his bleeding hand under the tap water as Lily started his car, Jack didn’t cry. Lily wasn’t leaving a man who had broken her heart, she was leaving a side of her life that had never fully belonged to just her.

So on that distant night in Los Angeles, Lily stood in her quiet hotel room over a pile of clothes she had bought in the prime of her first, and only, love and she cried. She cried for the days she had wasted, and the nights she had ignored. She cried for her heart, and she cried for the times she had told herself he had really loved her. She cried for her child. Lily abandoned the stolen air and went to the bathroom where she locked the door and drew a bath. She let the water grow hot enough to fill the air with steam so thick it felt sickening to breathe. She imagined it was the stale smoke lingering in her old

home, her heart and mind ached for at least one consistency. Lily sunk into the water and buried her head in the stillness, she blew bubbles out until she could no longer hold her lungs so still and burst to gasp for air into the clouded room. She felt her hair stick to her cheeks but didn't attempt to fix it. Lily let her heavy head slide back on the porcelain rim of the bath and cried again.

Non-Fiction

Michael Kenyon
Creative Writing

Heat, Hustle, and Heart: A Summer in New York City

I was nineteen when I moved to New York City, a kid with big dreams and a white chef's jacket that felt almost too clean for the kitchens I was about to enter. The city swallowed me whole in the best way possible. I lived in a tiny apartment on the Upper East Side, just a few subway stops from Midtown, where sirens mixed with car horns, people talking, and the constant noise of the city. Every morning, I walked past coffee carts and delis, smelling bagels and exhaust, and thought, This is where I'm supposed to be. I loved the energy of it, the late nights, the chaos, the feeling that anything could happen if I just kept moving.

That summer, I worked at two of the world's best restaurants, Eleven Madison Park and Oceana. Eleven Madison Park felt like another world. The kitchen was spotless and quiet, except for the sound of knives on cutting boards and chefs calling out orders. Everything mattered, from how a sauce was wiped on a plate to the posture of cooks on the line. The chefs moved fast and precise, and I realized that the dishes people saw were the result of work most people couldn't imagine.

I started at the bottom, which meant long hours, burns, and endless repetition. I spent hours cutting vegetables perfectly and organizing herbs until my hands smelled permanently like basil and thyme. Some tasks were exhausting, like the day I had to remove the casings from garden peas for eight hours straight. I wasn't allowed to talk, just work. The repetition stretched

time into a quiet kind of torture, and my fingers ached from the tiny motions, but that was just part of the job.

Other days, I was on the line during service, plating dishes as quickly as I could. The head chef would hover over me, telling me I was too slow and that I didn't belong there. I remember one night I had spent hours on a dish, trying to make it perfect, and he threw it in the trash before it even left the counter. I felt crushed, but I kept going. That's just how it was.

The work was intense. Every dish had to be exact. Desserts could collapse if you made a mistake, sauces could separate, seafood had to be perfect. One wrong move meant starting over. It wasn't just about cooking; it was about thinking fast, staying calm, and surviving under constant pressure. I learned to carry multiple tasks at once, keep my station clean while the orders piled up, and anticipate what would happen next before anyone asked. Every day was a test, and there was no margin for error.

I remember one Friday night when the dining room was full and the orders kept coming in faster than I could process them. I had three dishes to finish at once, each with different plating instructions. The heat from the stoves pressed down on my back, and the sound of the ticket printer felt like a constant reminder that one mistake would be noticed immediately. The chef was in my ear, criticizing every move, and yet I had to focus on each plate like my life depended on it. I finished the dishes, and one of them was thrown away because it wasn't perfect. I wanted to quit, but I just started the next order.

Then came Oceana. Seafood had its own challenges. The smell of the ocean stayed in the walk-in fridge, and every dish demanded care and speed at the same time. I learned to fillet fish,

prepare delicate dishes, and keep moving even when the kitchen felt chaotic. Sometimes, I would spend hours shucking oysters or portioning fish, careful not to cut myself while trying to keep up with the line. The sous chefs taught me how to plan ahead, clean as I went, and stay professional even when someone was yelling at me. The pace was exhausting, but I learned skills no classroom could teach.

Despite the excitement, the stress caught up to me. I couldn't sleep, replaying mistakes in my head. I worried constantly about letting the chefs down. I would come home after midnight, my body aching, and lie in bed thinking about if this is what I really wanted to do for my life. Some nights, I cried without even knowing why. I was proud to be there, but I felt like I couldn't keep up. Slowly, the passion I had for cooking started to fade. I loved food, but I started to dread the day ahead.

Even with the pressure, I tried to enjoy the city. I liked walking around at night, exploring neighborhoods, and trying different foods. Sometimes I would sit on a bench and just watch the city go by, the people, the lights, the energy. Other times, I would go to Central Park, find a spot in the grass, and just rest. I liked discovering little things: a street performer playing guitar, a food cart selling something new, or a small café tucked away on a side street. Those moments reminded me there was life outside the kitchen; those moments kept me feeling alive.

I also found small ways to keep myself grounded in the kitchen. I would notice how a sauce changed as it reduced, the way a soufflé puffed in the oven, or the smell of bread baking in the early morning. Those details reminded me why I wanted to be a chef in the first place. Even when everything was going wrong, there were little victories that kept me going.

Eventually, I made the hardest decision of that summer: I cut my externship short. I told myself it was temporary, but I knew I needed to step away. It felt like giving up, and I was embarrassed. I had worked so hard to get there, but I was breaking down. I remember sitting in my apartment after making the decision, hearing the city outside, feeling both relieved and sad. I had lost something, but I had also saved myself.

Looking back, it was the right choice. That experience tested me and pushed me in ways I didn't expect. It showed me that passion can't survive without balance, and that success means nothing if you lose yourself trying to achieve it. Stepping away helped me understand why I loved cooking, the creativity, the connection, and sharing something with others.

After New York, I spent time thinking about what I wanted to do next. I realized that while I loved food, I didn't want to be in the kitchen all the time, under that kind of pressure, dealing with the constant mental and physical stress. That experience helped me redirect my focus. I came to the University of Dayton and started exploring a degree in communications and business. It became clear to me that I could still be involved in the food industry, but in a different way, without the heat of the kitchen and the mental struggles that come with being a line cook. I could work in food media, restaurant management, or marketing and still use my skills and passion without burning myself out. That clarity came directly from everything I experienced in New York.

Over the past few years at UD, I've started to understand how much that summer shaped me. I approach my studies and work differently now. I can handle stress better because I know my limits. I can appreciate the small victories in my life and focus on what I enjoy without letting pressure take over. I still love cooking, but I don't want it to define my mental health or

my identity. Instead, I'm learning how to combine my passion with skills that will allow me to work in food in a sustainable way, whether that's in business, communications, or marketing.

By the end of that summer, I was different. My hands were sore, my body tired, but my mind was clearer. I had survived something that felt impossible. Even now, I miss parts of it, the energy of the kitchen, walking home late at night, eating food I couldn't get anywhere else, and living in a city that never slowed down. New York shaped me in ways I'm still figuring out. It taught me that growth often happens in hard places, and that passion and pressure can exist together if you learn how to manage them. It also taught me the importance of knowing your limits and making decisions that protect your well-being.

Someday, I will go back to New York, not just for the restaurants or the energy, but for the version of myself that believed anything was possible. For all the stress and long nights, it was the happiest I had ever been, and it showed me who I want to be. Now, I'm focused on building a career that balances my love for food with skills in business and communications, so I can make an impact without sacrificing my mental health or personal life. That's the biggest lesson I took from my time in the city: passion is important, but it has to be sustainable.

Final Reflection Questions:

1. Which piece did you revise in the most depth?

The piece I revised the most was my fiction story *Up In Ashes*. I added more detail to the characters and slowed down important scenes so the emotions felt stronger. My first draft moved too fast, so I focused on pacing, dialogue, and making Lily and Jack feel real. The revision helped the whole story feel fuller and more developed.

2. Did you enjoy the workshops or find them useful?

I did find the workshops helpful, especially the small-group ones. Hearing people respond to my writing showed me things I didn't catch on my own. I also enjoyed reading classmates' work because it gave me new ideas. The online ones were convenient, but the in-person workshops felt more helpful.

3. What are your greatest strengths as a writer?

I think one of my strengths is writing with strong detail and emotion. I like creating scenes that feel real and characters with depth. I also write honestly, even in fiction, which helps my work feel grounded.

4. What weaknesses or areas of improvement do you see?

I sometimes overwrite or add too many details. I also second-guess myself a lot, which slows me down. I want to get better at clarity and making sure every line has a purpose, especially in dialogue.

5. How does your culture/context/world impact your writing?

My writing is shaped by my experiences, especially growing up around food, working in kitchens, and moving between different environments. I tend to write about relationships, pressure, and emotion because those are things I've lived through and seen up close.

6. If you were starting over, what would you do differently?

I would start drafts earlier and give myself more time to revise. I'd also push myself to take more risks instead of sticking to what felt safe. And I would try to contribute more during workshops.

7. Anything else you'd like to share?

I really enjoyed this class and the freedom to try different genres. The environment made it easy to share personal work. More small-group workshops or extra prompts would be a nice addition, but overall, this course helped me grow a lot as a writer.

THANK YOU!!